

AI NEWS GAME

THE FACILITATOR WILL PRESENT A NEWS STORY. DISCUSS HOW TO REPORT IT, THEN MARK ONE CHOICE IN EVERY TASK ROW.

Team / player: _____

Round: _____

REPORTING DESK

Gather information and produce stories.

Research & Source Discovery Find background, documents, experts, and sources.	HUMAN A journalist finds background, documents, experts, and sources.	AI AI identifies background, documents, experts, and sources automatically.	HUMAN + AI AI identifies possible material, and a journalist reviews and selects the sources.
Interview Processing Conduct, transcribe, summarize, and organize interviews.	HUMAN A journalist conducts, transcribes, summarizes, and organizes the interviews.	AI AI transcribes, summarizes, and organizes the interview material automatically.	HUMAN + AI AI processes the interviews, and a journalist checks the transcript and summary.
Document Review Review reports, filings, studies, records, and primary documents.	HUMAN A journalist reads the documents and identifies relevant evidence.	AI AI reviews the documents and extracts relevant evidence automatically.	HUMAN + AI AI extracts possible evidence, and a journalist checks it against the documents.
Data Gathering & Analysis Collect, organize, and analyze data for patterns and insights.	HUMAN A journalist gathers the data and analyzes it for patterns and insights.	AI AI gathers, organizes, and analyzes the data automatically.	HUMAN + AI AI analyzes the data, and a journalist reviews the methods and findings.
News Writing Draft stories based on gathered information.	HUMAN A journalist writes the story from the gathered information.	AI AI drafts the story automatically from the gathered information.	HUMAN + AI AI produces a draft, and a journalist reviews and revises it.

EDITING DESK

Set priorities and strengthen accuracy.

Editorial Planning Decide newsroom priorities and allocate coverage resources.	HUMAN Editors set priorities and decide how newsroom resources are allocated.	AI AI recommends priorities and resource allocations automatically.	HUMAN + AI AI recommends a plan, and editors review and approve the priorities.
Story Editing Improve clarity, structure, and readability.	HUMAN An editor revises the story for clarity, structure, and readability.	AI AI revises the story for clarity, structure, and readability automatically.	HUMAN + AI AI suggests revisions, and an editor decides which changes to make.
Fact Checking Verify claims and evidence.	HUMAN A journalist verifies claims and evidence against original sources.	AI AI checks claims and evidence automatically against available sources.	HUMAN + AI AI flags claims and evidence, and a journalist verifies them against original sources.
Bias & Fairness Review Assess framing, balance, and missing perspectives.	HUMAN An editor assesses the framing, balance, and missing perspectives.	AI AI identifies possible bias, imbalance, and missing perspectives automatically.	HUMAN + AI AI flags possible concerns, and an editor makes the fairness judgment.
Content Selection Decide what gets published, promoted, and given prominence.	HUMAN Editors decide what is published, promoted, and given prominence.	AI AI selects what is published, promoted, and given prominence automatically.	HUMAN + AI AI recommends what to feature, and editors make the final selection.

PACKAGING DESK

Shape how stories appear.

Headline Writing Create titles and subheads.	HUMAN A journalist writes the titles and subheads.	AI AI generates the titles and subheads automatically.	HUMAN + AI AI generates options, and a journalist selects and revises the final wording.
Story Summarization Produce previews, abstracts, and key takeaways.	HUMAN A journalist writes the previews, abstracts, and key takeaways.	AI AI produces previews, abstracts, and key takeaways automatically.	HUMAN + AI AI produces a summary, and a journalist checks its emphasis and accuracy.
Visual Creation Create images, graphics, charts, and thumbnails.	HUMAN A journalist or designer creates the visuals for the story.	AI AI generates the images, graphics, charts, or thumbnails automatically.	HUMAN + AI AI generates visual options, and a journalist or designer reviews and refines them.
Format Adaptation Adapt content for newsletters, video, mobile, social, and more.	HUMAN A journalist adapts the story for each platform and format.	AI AI adapts the story for different platforms and formats automatically.	HUMAN + AI AI creates platform versions, and a journalist reviews each adaptation.
Story Promotion Create teasers, captions, and push notifications.	HUMAN A journalist writes the teasers, captions, and push notifications.	AI AI generates the promotional language automatically.	HUMAN + AI AI generates promotional options, and a journalist selects and revises them.

AUDIENCE DESK

Distribute stories and build relationships.

Search Optimization Improve discoverability through search.	HUMAN A journalist improves the story's search terms and discoverability.	AI AI optimizes the story for search automatically.	HUMAN + AI AI recommends search changes, and a journalist reviews them before publication.
Social Distribution Publish and adapt content for social platforms.	HUMAN A journalist publishes and adapts the story for social platforms.	AI AI publishes and adapts the story across social platforms automatically.	HUMAN + AI AI prepares social posts, and a journalist reviews them before distribution.
Audience Targeting Decide which audiences receive content.	HUMAN A journalist decides which audiences should receive the story.	AI AI selects and targets audiences automatically.	HUMAN + AI AI recommends audience segments, and a journalist approves the targeting.
Performance Analysis Monitor engagement and audience behavior.	HUMAN A journalist monitors engagement and interprets audience behavior.	AI AI monitors engagement and analyzes audience behavior automatically.	HUMAN + AI AI identifies performance patterns, and a journalist interprets what they mean.
Community Management Manage comments, audience interactions, and online communities.	HUMAN A journalist manages comments, interactions, and community relationships.	AI AI moderates comments and manages audience interactions automatically.	HUMAN + AI AI handles routine interactions, and a journalist reviews decisions and sensitive exchanges.

AFTER ALL DECISIONS, COUNT:

TASKS WITH HUMANS (Human or Human + AI): ____ / 20

TASKS WITH AI (AI or Human + AI): ____ / 20

You are given 10 facilitator cards, which include stories players will work on and facilitation instructions. Randomize and draw one for each round of the game.

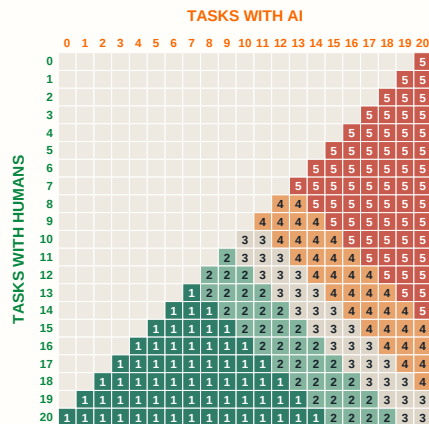
FACILITATOR CARD

Transit proposal would redraw three bus routes

Make the plan useful quickly without overlooking neighborhoods that could lose service.

- Where could AI make a complicated route proposal easier to use?
- What might automated analysis miss about how residents actually travel?
- Which audience questions would require human judgment?

- Count tasks involving humans: Human or Human + AI. This is the row.
- Count tasks involving AI: AI or Human + AI. This is the column.
- The number where row and column meet is the AI dependence score.**



Use each player or team's AI dependence score:

AI DEPENDENCE		1	2	3	4	5
REACH		VERY LOW	LOW	AVERAGE	HIGH	VERY HIGH
TRUST		VERY HIGH	HIGH	AVERAGE	LOW	VERY LOW

Does it match expectations? What does this baseline assume about AI, Reach, and Trust?

Not all stories are the same. For each matching assignment, move the named outcome one level.

- **IF Format Adaptation = AI or Human + AI: UPGRADE REACH ONE LEVEL.**
Audience reason: Multiple formats help riders find the changes that affect them.
- **IF Data Gathering & Analysis = AI only: DOWNGRADE TRUST ONE LEVEL.**
Audience reason: Unreviewed route analysis may miss local travel patterns.
- **IF Community Management = Human or Human + AI: UPGRADE TRUST ONE LEVEL.**
Audience reason: Human attention helps address riders' specific questions.

FINAL REACH _____ FINAL TRUST _____

D. TELL PLAYERS THE FINAL RESULT. DISCUSS: Which effect changed it? Does it fit this story?

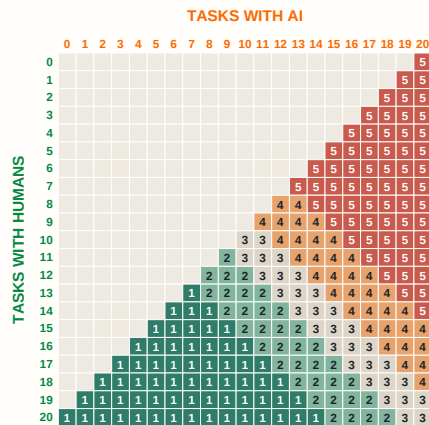
FACILITATOR CARD

Flood warning issued after overnight rain

Reach people quickly while keeping urgent information accurate and current.

- Where could AI help urgent information reach people faster?
- Which errors would create the greatest immediate harm?
- Who should decide which updates deserve the most attention?

- Count tasks involving humans: Human or Human + AI. This is the row.
- Count tasks involving AI: AI or Human + AI. This is the column.
- The number where row and column meet is the AI dependence score.**



Use each player or team's AI dependence score:

AI DEPENDENCE		1	2	3	4	5
REACH		VERY LOW	LOW	AVERAGE	HIGH	VERY HIGH
TRUST		VERY HIGH	HIGH	AVERAGE	LOW	VERY LOW

Does it match expectations? What does this baseline assume about AI, Reach, and Trust?

Not all stories are the same. For each matching assignment, move the named outcome one level.

- **IF Social Distribution = AI or Human + AI: UPGRADE REACH ONE LEVEL.**
Audience reason: Rapid distribution helps urgent information travel.
- **IF Fact Checking = AI only: DOWNGRADE TRUST ONE LEVEL.**
Audience reason: An unreviewed mistake can create immediate harm.
- **IF Content Selection = Human or Human + AI: UPGRADE TRUST ONE LEVEL.**
Audience reason: Editorial judgment keeps the most urgent updates prominent.

FINAL REACH	FINAL TRUST
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D. TELL PLAYERS THE FINAL RESULT. DISCUSS: Which effect changed it? Does it fit this story?

STORY 05 / SCHOOLS

FACILITATOR CARD

STEP 1: INTRODUCE THE STORY

Tell players which story they are working on. Read the story and questions aloud.

District considers changing school start times

The proposal affects transportation, after-school programs, family schedules, and student sleep. The district will hold listening sessions.

WHAT MATTERS HERE

Represent the people affected and explain consequences across the community.

DISCUSS BEFORE ASSIGNING

Which personal accounts could lose meaning through automation?

Could AI help reach families with different information needs?

Which community concerns require a person to respond?

STEP 2: CALCULATE AI DEPENDENCE

1. Count tasks involving humans: Human or Human + AI. This is the row.

2. Count tasks involving AI: AI or Human + AI. This is the column.

3. The number where row and column meet is the AI dependence score.

TASKS WITH AI

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15 16 17 18 19 20

TASKS WITH HUMANS

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15 16 17 18 19 20

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15 16 17 18 19 20

STEP 3: CALCULATE AUDIENCE OUTCOMES

A. SET THE BASELINE AUDIENCE SCORES

Use each player or team's AI dependence score:

AI DEPENDENCE

1 2 3 4 5

REACH VERY LOW LOW AVERAGE HIGH VERY HIGH

TRUST VERY HIGH HIGH AVERAGE LOW VERY LOW

B. TELL PLAYERS THEIR BASELINE. DISCUSS:

Does it match expectations? What does this baseline assume about AI, Reach, and Trust?

C. APPLY THIS STORY'S BONUSES AND PENALTIES

Not all stories are the same. For each matching assignment, move the named outcome one level.

IF Interview Processing = Human or Human + AI: UPGRADE TRUST ONE LEVEL.

Audience reason: Review protects nuance in students' and families' accounts.

IF Audience Targeting = AI or Human + AI: UPGRADE REACH ONE LEVEL.

Audience reason: Targeting can reach families with different information needs.

IF Community Management = AI only: DOWNGRADE TRUST ONE LEVEL.

Audience reason: Automated responses can mishandle personal concerns.

FINAL REACH FINAL TRUST

D. TELL PLAYERS THE FINAL RESULT. DISCUSS: Which effect changed it? Does it fit this story?

STORY 06 / LOCAL LIFE

FACILITATOR CARD

STEP 1: INTRODUCE THE STORY

Tell players which story they are working on. Read the story and questions aloud.

Small businesses face a new permit deadline

A new online filing process begins next week. Some owners say the instructions are confusing and available only in English.

WHAT MATTERS HERE

Make the requirements accessible to the people who need to act.

DISCUSS BEFORE ASSIGNING

Could AI make the permit instructions easier to summarize or translate?

Which formats would help owners find and use the information?

What language or access barriers might automation overlook?

STEP 2: CALCULATE AI DEPENDENCE

1. Count tasks involving humans: Human or Human + AI. This is the row.

2. Count tasks involving AI: AI or Human + AI. This is the column.

3. The number where row and column meet is the AI dependence score.

TASKS WITH AI

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15 16 17 18 19 20

TASKS WITH HUMANS

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15 16 17 18 19 20

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15 16 17 18 19 20

STEP 3: CALCULATE AUDIENCE OUTCOMES

A. SET THE BASELINE AUDIENCE SCORES

Use each player or team's AI dependence score:

AI DEPENDENCE

1 2 3 4 5

REACH VERY LOW LOW AVERAGE HIGH VERY HIGH

TRUST VERY HIGH HIGH AVERAGE LOW VERY LOW

B. TELL PLAYERS THEIR BASELINE. DISCUSS:

Does it match expectations? What does this baseline assume about AI, Reach, and Trust?

C. APPLY THIS STORY'S BONUSES AND PENALTIES

Not all stories are the same. For each matching assignment, move the named outcome one level.

IF Story Summarization = AI or Human + AI: UPGRADE REACH ONE LEVEL.

Audience reason: A concise checklist makes the requirements easier to use.

IF Format Adaptation = AI or Human + AI: UPGRADE REACH ONE LEVEL.

Audience reason: Multiple formats can reach owners across platforms.

IF Bias & Fairness Review = AI only: DOWNGRADE TRUST ONE LEVEL.

Audience reason: Automated review may miss language and access barriers.

FINAL REACH FINAL TRUST

D. TELL PLAYERS THE FINAL RESULT. DISCUSS: Which effect changed it? Does it fit this story?

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FACILITATOR CARDS

You are given 10 facilitator cards, which include stories players will work on and facilitation instructions. Randomize and draw one for each round of the game.

STORY 07 / CLIMATE

FACILITATOR CARD

STEP 1: INTRODUCE THE STORY

Tell players which story they are working on. Read the story and questions aloud.

City opens cooling centers during a heat emergency

Temperatures are expected to remain dangerous for three days. Hours, transportation, and capacity differ among locations.

WHAT MATTERS HERE

Distribute accurate, accessible information to residents at greatest risk.

DISCUSS BEFORE ASSIGNING

- Where could AI help residents locate cooling centers quickly?
- Which mistakes in maps or hours could create safety risks?
- What information should a person verify before publication?

STEP 2: CALCULATE AI DEPENDENCE

1. Count tasks involving humans: Human or Human + AI. This is the row.

2. Count tasks involving AI: AI or Human + AI. This is the column.

3. The number where row and column meet is the AI dependence score.

TASKS WITH AI

TASKS WITH HUMANS

STEP 3: CALCULATE AUDIENCE OUTCOMES

A. SET THE BASELINE AUDIENCE SCORES

Use each player or team's AI dependence score:

AI DEPENDENCE

	1	2	3	4	5
REACH	VERY LOW	LOW	AVERAGE	HIGH	VERY HIGH
TRUST	VERY HIGH	HIGH	AVERAGE	LOW	VERY LOW

B. TELL PLAYERS THEIR BASELINE. DISCUSS:

Does it match expectations? What does this baseline assume about AI, Reach, and Trust?

C. APPLY THIS STORY'S BONUSES AND PENALTIES

Not all stories are the same. For each matching assignment, move the named outcome one level.

- IF Search Optimization = AI or Human + AI: UPGRADE REACH ONE LEVEL. Audience reason: Search visibility helps residents find locations quickly.
- IF Visual Creation = AI only: DOWNGRADE TRUST ONE LEVEL. Audience reason: Generated maps may introduce dangerous location errors.
- IF Fact Checking = Human or Human + AI: UPGRADE TRUST ONE LEVEL. Audience reason: Human review confirms locations, hours, and transportation.

FINAL REACH _____ FINAL TRUST _____

D. TELL PLAYERS THE FINAL RESULT. DISCUSS: Which effect changed it? Does it fit this story?

STORY 08 / GOVERNMENT

FACILITATOR CARD

STEP 1: INTRODUCE THE STORY

Tell players which story they are working on. Read the story and questions aloud.

Public records reveal delays in safety inspections

Records show a growing backlog, but agencies dispute how the delays should be measured and whether residents were placed at risk.

WHAT MATTERS HERE

Build defensible conclusions from incomplete records and competing explanations.

DISCUSS BEFORE ASSIGNING

- Where could AI help process a large collection of public records?
- How could an automated definition of delay distort the findings?
- Which conclusions require human judgment about the evidence?

STEP 2: CALCULATE AI DEPENDENCE

1. Count tasks involving humans: Human or Human + AI. This is the row.

2. Count tasks involving AI: AI or Human + AI. This is the column.

3. The number where row and column meet is the AI dependence score.

TASKS WITH AI

TASKS WITH HUMANS

STEP 3: CALCULATE AUDIENCE OUTCOMES

A. SET THE BASELINE AUDIENCE SCORES

Use each player or team's AI dependence score:

AI DEPENDENCE

	1	2	3	4	5
REACH	VERY LOW	LOW	AVERAGE	HIGH	VERY HIGH
TRUST	VERY HIGH	HIGH	AVERAGE	LOW	VERY LOW

B. TELL PLAYERS THEIR BASELINE. DISCUSS:

Does it match expectations? What does this baseline assume about AI, Reach, and Trust?

C. APPLY THIS STORY'S BONUSES AND PENALTIES

Not all stories are the same. For each matching assignment, move the named outcome one level.

- IF Document Review = AI or Human + AI: UPGRADE REACH ONE LEVEL. Audience reason: Assisted review can process a large record set.
- IF Data Gathering & Analysis = AI only: DOWNGRADE TRUST ONE LEVEL. Audience reason: Unreviewed analysis may encode a misleading definition of delay.
- IF News Writing = Human or Human + AI: UPGRADE TRUST ONE LEVEL. Audience reason: Human judgment helps match the claims to the evidence.

FINAL REACH _____ FINAL TRUST _____

D. TELL PLAYERS THE FINAL RESULT. DISCUSS: Which effect changed it? Does it fit this story?

You are given 10 facilitator cards, which include stories players will work on and facilitation instructions. Randomize and draw one for each round of the game.

FACILITATOR CARD

FACILITATOR CARD

D. TELL PLAYERS THE FINAL RESULT. DISCUSS: Which effect changed it? Does it fit this story?